



Webinar - Episode 5

Mental Health Conditions, fitness for work, and IMEs

*Presentations by Dr Lorenzo Grespi and Dr William Badenhorst
(Consultant Psychiatrists and Medical Directors at Grespi) on mental health
claims management in the age of COVID-19, with questions to follow
8th October 2020 11:00 to 12:15*

CLICK THE LINK BELOW TO ACCESS VIDEO RECORDING

<https://vimeo.com/466259779/90b76766b7>



Health Claims Forum: Grespi webinar 1

Mental health conditions, fitness for work and IME reports

www.grespi.com

Mental health conditions



- What is a mental health condition?
- What is not a mental health condition?
 - "Stress"
 - "Psychological vulnerability/fragility"
 - "Good days and bad days"
 - etc.

www.grespi.com

Diagnosis



- What is the meaning and value of a diagnosis
- Strengths and limitations of diagnoses

www.grespi.com

ICD-10



- ICD-10: what is it about?
- ICD-10: what is it and what it is not?
- ICD-10: what to look for in the ICD-10 when evaluating a mental health claim?

www.grespi.com

Mental health conditions and fitness for work



- What makes a condition incompatible with work/return to work?
- Examples of conditions that are compatible with work/return to work

www.grespi.com

.... the mostly-missing bit: **THE FORMULATION**



- What is/what is not a formulation?
- Examples of formulations
- Importance of the formulation when assessing a mental health claim
- Why is the formulation mostly missing from IME psychiatric reports?
- When it is missing, what can/should the claim assessor ask the assessing clinician?

www.grespi.com

What to expect from IME psychiatric reports



- Case-specific formulation, underpinned by:
 - background history
 - clinical evidence
- Case-specific formulation, leading to:
 - diagnosis
 - prognosis
 - recommendations

www.grespi.com

Formulation and mental health claims



Formulation as the case-specific rationale to evaluate:

- Fitness to work
- Fitness to attend insurance and employment-related meetings
- Return to work prospects and timeframe
- Disability
- Treatment/support/mediation to:
 - facilitate the return to work process
 - prevent/minimise the occurrence of relapses

www.grespi.com

What should IME psychiatric reports cover? - 1



- Referral background
- 'The brief'
- The setting: face-to-face/Skype; clinic/home visit; duration
- Current circumstances (work, sick leave, private life)
- Relevant references to:
 - personal and family history
 - work history
 - medical history
 - mental health history

www.grespi.com

What should IME psychiatric reports cover? - 2



- Mental state - with references to risk and safeguarding
- Diagnosis
- Formulation/clinical impression
- Disability under Equality Act 2010
- Prognosis

www.grespi.com

What should IME psychiatric reports cover? - 3



- Fitness to:
 - work
 - attend insurance and employment-related meetings
- Return to work prospects and timeframe
- Reasonable adjustments in the workplace
- Recommendations:
 - treatment
 - support re: return to work/end of employment
 - mediation
 - reference to copies of the report being sent (with consent) to the claimant's GP and relevant clinicians

www.grespi.com

Do	Don't
TRIAGE and seek support	Put your head in the sand!
Be consistent in seeking clinical input	Promise "whatever you need"
Identify challenges and consider how to address them	Authorise interventions without a clear, individualised rationale

www.grespi.com

Covid-19 and mental health claims



- Stressor and the capacity to cope with stressors:
 - personality
 - core features of stressors
 - support systems
- 'Anxiety'
 - as an ordinary response to difficult life experiences
 - as a symptom
- 'Stress': a state of mind of feeling under pressure

www.grespi.com

Pandemic as a cumulative stressor



*Coexistence and accumulation of wide-ranging stressors,
occurring within a short period of time
in a constantly-changing environment*

www.grespi.com

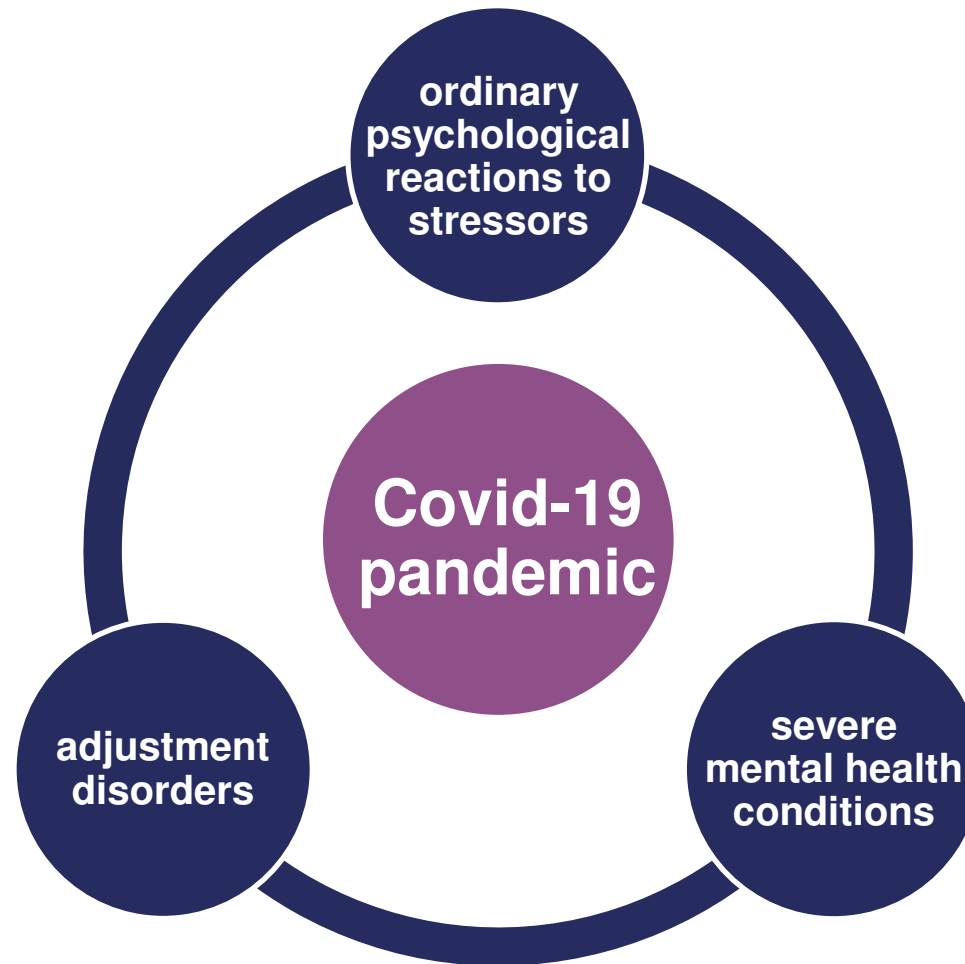
Pandemic-related stressors



- concerns about potential virus infection
- mistrust in others
- social and emotional isolation
- travel to/from work
- working in an indoor office environment
- worries about the restructuring of the company
- furlough
- potential loss of income
- redundancies
- job loss

www.grespi.com

Covid-19 and mental health



www.grespi.com

Pandemic as stressor triggering Adjustment Disorders



- Time-limited
- Tend to resolve when:
 - stressful circumstances improve
 - individuals make necessary psychological adjustments
 - professional help is provided

www.grespi.com

Pandemic as stressor triggering other mental health conditions



- New mental health conditions in individuals with pre-existing psychological vulnerabilities
- Relapse of historical mental health conditions
- Examples of 'at risk' mental health conditions:
 - depressive episodes
 - decompensated personality disorders
 - psychotic disorders

www.grespi.com

Managing mental health claims during the pandemic: a few tips



- Containment through communication
- Review of medical documentation
- 'Stress, 'Anxiety', 'Depression' and 'PTSD': request clarification re:
 - ICD-10
 - history of current condition and related triggers/stressors
 - steps taken re: assessment, treatment, support
- Triage with insurance psychiatric assessor
- Clear letter of instruction re: psychiatric IME

DO NOT DELAY THE REFERRAL FOR AN IME!

www.grespi.com



Thank you!

info@grespi.com

www.grespi.com

0845 601 6036

 @grespi